



q & a

**Your Questions,
Our Answers**



All your computer
niggles and nags are
dealt with here!

Q Lost data – need help!

I have a Western Digital Caviar 1600AAB55 160-GB hard drive. It has six partitions. The Disk Management utility on Windows XP SP3 indicated 50 GB of free space. I wanted to create a new logical partition. When I attempted to make one of 10 GB, Windows needed to restart to register the partition. After restarting, the My Computer window showed me the drive details. However, when I tried to open the new volume, they refused to do so, stating that the disk was not formatted. I performed a quick format on both the new volumes. They now open, but I've lost approximately 40 GB of data. I want to get my original partition and data back. Is this possible?

Naveen Chand

A Before you re-partitioned your drive, your system was using some 148 GB of space. After repartitioning to include a new 50-GB partition, you've lost some 40 GB of space. Use data recovery software to try and recover some of the data. Try using Acronis Disk Director. There is no guarantee you'll be able to recover all the data back.

Q Problem with playing certain formats

I have downloaded a WMV file, but I can't play it. I have also tried converting it to AVI or MPEG, but I get some error messages.

Saktidip Chakma

A WMV is Windows Media Video and is supported by the Windows operating system. The only reason you may not be able to play it is if the video you downloaded is encoded using WMV 10 codecs. You can download and install the codecs and also the latest version of Windows Media Player from Microsoft's web site.

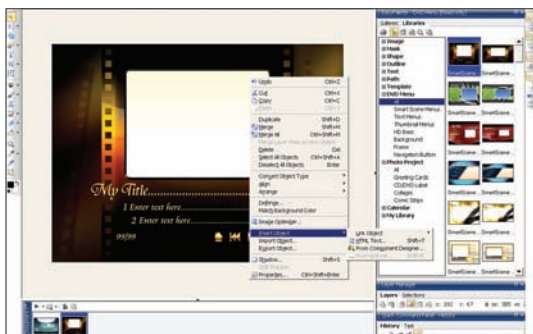
Q Problems with opening PDF files

When I try to download documents from a site, a message "Adobe Reader – File does not begin with %PDF" appears and I'm unable to get the file from the site. I have installed Adobe Acrobat Reader 9.0 on Windows XP Professional.

Balasubramanian E

A Try re-installing Adobe Reader 9. See if this fixes the problem. If you really need to download PDF files from your browser, right-click on the link to the PDF and click Save Link As. Save the file on your drive, then use Adobe Reader to open it. If you continue having trouble using Adobe Reader, you can also try a free PDF reader such as Foxit Reader from www.foxitsoftware.com.

Q Software trial period ended



PhotoImpact x3 is a commercial software that needs to be purchased to use beyond the trial period

I recently installed a trial version of Corel PhotoImpact X3 and has now expired. When I re-installed it, it said that the trial period was over. What should I do?

Varun Singh

A Trial software is meant to expire

GParted

A popular utility used for
disk partitioning

after a fixed period. You need to then purchase a copy of the software or enter a serial key for the software to run again.

Q Boot problems

I had a 40 GB Samsung SV4002H hard disk with four partitions and Windows 98 SE, a few years back. Due to a power outage, I could not boot into Windows 98 SE. I could access the other three partitions of the drive.

I recently upgraded my PC and also got a new hard disk. It's a Seagate 250-GB ST3250310AS drive. I made six partitions and also installed Windows XP Professional SP3 on it. After tweaking around a little, I was able to access the other three partitions on my Samsung drive, but not the previous primary drive that had Windows 98 SE on it. I was also unable to format the drive using XP.

A few days back, I installed Vista on another partition on the Seagate 250 GB drive, but I did not get a dual-boot menu during boot up. It automatically booted into XP. There is an entry for only one OS in the Bootup Settings in Startup and Recovery.

I am only able to boot Vista using the Vista DVD. I tried to repair the Startup using the XP CD as well as the Vista DVD. With the XP CD, I used the fixboot and the fixmbr commands. I typed the fixboot command and pressed Y to confirm the command. A success message was displayed. But when I typed fixmbr the following message was displayed,

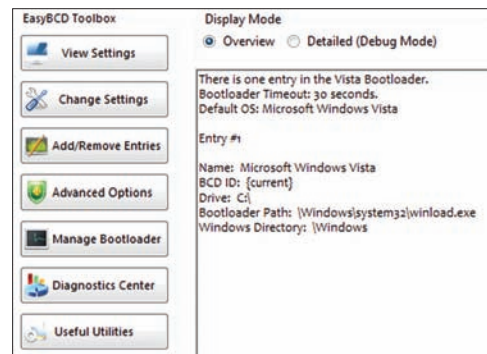
****CAUTION****

This computer appears to have a non-standard or invalid master boot record.

FIXMBR may damage your partition tables if you proceed.

This could cause all the partitions on the current hard disk to be inaccessible.

If you are not having problems accessing your drive, do not continue.



EasyBCD allows you to modify the boot loader settings

Are you
sure you want
to write a new
MBR?"

I pressed N.
I could
not format
the damaged
partition on
the Samsung
Harddisk even
with Vista. I
just want to get
a boot menu
where I can
select the OS I
want to boot.

Syed

A The problems you are facing are due to the boot records for each of the operating systems written on two separate drives. Also, try switching the boot order of your hard drives. Try booting from the newer 250-GB drive instead of the 40 GB. If you just want to be able to boot using the new 250-GB drive, first physically disconnect the 40 GB. The Vista boot loader can be modified easily using a software called EasyBCD. It is available for download from <http://neosmart.net/dl.php?id=1>.

Q GPS On Blackberry?

I have bought a new Blackberry Curve 8900 that is supposed to be GPS-enabled. However, there is no application to operate it! How can I use GPS on the phone?

Harsh